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Software Engineer

Office for National Statistics

Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 8th October 2026

Reference number

482904

Salary

£34,587

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Higher Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

ONS - Digital and Technology - Social Surveys

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

2

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Location

The locations for this role are Newport and Titchfield (Fareham).

This role is aligned to ONS hybrid working principles, which are based on attending the office with purpose. The postholder will be expected to contribute to the organisation's overall 40% office attendance, in line with business and role requirements.

The induction process for the role will be conducted in person.

Due to workforce controls you can only select Manchester / London / Darlington / Edinburgh / Belfast if you are an existing ONS employee contracted to that location. If you are not contracted at one of these sites, these options are not available to you.

Only existing ONS contractual homeworkers can select Homeworking.

Applicants who select a location they are not eligible for will be removed from the recruitment process and will not be considered for alternative locations.

Please refer to attachments for further terms and flexibilities.

About the job

Job summary

The Office for National Statistics (ONS) is the UK's largest producer of official statistics, covering a range of key economic, social and demographic topics. These include measuring changes in the value of the UK economy, estimating the size, geographic distribution and characteristics of the population, and providing indicators of price inflation, employment, earnings, crime and migration.

This role sits within Social Surveys Central Division (SSCD) which provide strategic direction and plans, leadership and coordination of cross-cutting

strategic priorities, directorate-wide governance and assurance, programme & change management, and business support.

This central area ensures alignment, coordination, and the effective execution of these critical functions across the Social Surveys Directorate.

Job description

We are looking for a Blaise Software Engineer to join our active community of technical professionals.

Social Surveys Research and Production (SSRP) produces a series of high-profile research and statistical outputs for customers across the public and private sector. SSRP is a team of over 120 people organised into a series of areas. Each of these has responsibility for the delivery, and transformation, of social surveys or/and specialist functions (such as Survey Computing) that support survey delivery. This post sits within the Blaise Development, Standards and Support team. We develop questionnaires for Social Surveys and support transformation activities as well as providing support and training for Social Survey research teams. This is an exciting time to join the Blaise team with development work on-going to support the transformation journey that Social Survey Divisions have embarked upon.

You will be responsible for developing social surveys and supporting Survey teams across the division using programming and scripting skills to resolve issues or provide solutions. There are also potential opportunities to lead on small projects across the division to meet user needs.

General responsibilities:

Designing software products to serve a variety of user needs and enhancing existing software products to meet evolving user needs.

Ensuring a quality software product is delivered and maintained.

Being a practitioner in the use of technologies and tools, evaluating and adopting those appropriate for the environment.

Supporting an environment where continuous or on demand delivery can be enabled if needed by the business, using effective delivery and deployment techniques.

Maintaining and supporting services, identifying, locating and competently fixing faults, and taking pro-active actions to avoid service disruption.

Sharing knowledge of tools and techniques; identifying and sharing good practices and collaborating to improve the capability of the team

Key responsibilities:

Develop and enhance software solutions to meet user story needs.

Follow best practice guidelines and help to improve those guidelines.

Write clean, secure, and well-tested code.

Coach and mentor colleagues.

Support a continuous delivery environment, using effective delivery and deployment techniques.

Operate the services they build and identify issues in production.

Design and execute a range of test techniques.

Person specification

Essential Skills Criteria

Programming and build (Software

Engineering)(Practitioner) Collaborates with others when necessary to review specifications. Uses these agreed specifications to design, code, test and document programs or scripts of medium to high complexity, using the right standards and tools. Contributes to code reviews and gives constructive feedback to others.

Test Engineering(Working) Able to design, build, maintain and execute tests that align to user needs and requirements. Able to select appropriate test types and techniques with some support. Follows good engineering practices and standards (including source control and CI/CD pipelines) and integrates tests early to enable continuous feedback. Able to create and maintain automated tests, with some support.

Service support(Working) Able to help fix service faults following agreed procedures. Able to carry out maintenance tasks on service support infrastructure.

Communicating between technical and non-technical(Working) Able to communicate effectively with technical and non-technical stakeholders. Able to support and host discussions within a multidisciplinary team. Be an advocate for the team externally. Able to manage differing stakeholder perspectives

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Communicating and Influencing

Working Together

Delivering at Pace

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Programming and Build (Practitioner)

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £34,587, Office for National Statistics contributes £10,019 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

The [Office for National Statistics](#) is part of the Civil Service, and as such we share a number of key benefits with other departments, whilst also having our own unique offerings to support our valued colleagues across the organisation.

Whether you are hearing about us for the first time or already know a bit about our organisation, we hope that our [careers site](#) will give you a great insight into the benefits and facilities available to our colleagues, and our fantastic working culture.



Inclusion & Accessibility

At ONS we are always looking to attract the very best people from the widest possible talent pool, and we are proud to be an inclusive, equal opportunities employer. As a Disability Confident Leader we are committed to ensuring that all candidates are treated fairly throughout the recruitment process.

As part of our application process, you will be prompted to provide details of any reasonable adjustments to our recruitment process that you need. If you would like to discuss any reasonable adjustments before applying, please contact the recruitment team in the first instance.

If you would like an accessible version of any of the attachments or recruitment documents below or linked to in this advert, please contact the recruitment team who will be happy to assist.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Security Clearance

For ONS the requirement for SC clearance is to have been present in the UK for 3 consecutive years immediately prior to applying and the department will consider eligibility by exception on a case-by-case basis. You will be asked to provide information regarding your UK residency during your application, and failure to provide this will result in your application being rejected.

If you are unsure that you meet the eligibility above, please read the information available on Gov.uk on this link, or contact the recruitment email on the advert before applying to discuss, as failure to meet the residency requirements will result in your security clearance application being rejected and any offer of employment being withdrawn.

At the point of SC application, you will need to provide or give access to the following evidence:

Departmental or company records (personnel files, staff reports, sick leave reports and security records)

UK criminal records covering both spent and unspent criminal records

Your credit and financial history with a credit reference agency

Security Services records

Visa Sponsorship

ONS is unable to offer visa sponsorship for this role. Applicants must have a valid right to work in the UK when employment commences. If you are currently in the UK on a time-limited visa, it must have at least 18 months remaining at the point of application.

Right to Work and Nationality Requirements

To work at ONS, applicants must meet the Civil Service nationality requirements, satisfy UK right to work requirements and, where applicable, meet the relevant security clearance requirements.

If you are unsure whether you meet the appropriate right to work or security clearance eligibility criteria, please refer to the guidance on [Gov.uk](https://www.gov.uk) or contact the recruitment email provided in the advert **before applying**. Failure to meet these requirements will result in your application being rejected and employment offers being withdrawn.

For full guidance in relation to the use of AI through the recruitment process, please read [A candidate's guide to artificial intelligence \(AI\) in recruitment](#)

Please note that all campaigns may be subject to withdrawal at any stage if the internal resource position changes.

Application Process

Number of Stages: 2 stage process

Stage 1: Application

Stage 2: Interview

Stage 1 Application

The assessment process at the application stage will be based on your work history, skills, experience, CV, and personal statement. It is important that your application is tailored to highlight the skills, knowledge, and experience relevant to the role.

A personal statement is required at application stage, the maximum wordcount allowed is 1250 words, which should not be exceeded. You should provide evidence for each essential skill criterion listed in the person specification. As these criteria are scored, it is advisable to give clear examples for each one, including the impact of your actions, ideally utilising the STAR technique (Situation, Task, Action, Result).

Please note that Success Profiles Behaviour examples are not required at this stage of the application process.

When a high volume of applications are received, the sift pass mark may be adjusted. Candidates will be invited to interview based on their merit order, with those achieving the highest scores being prioritised. Applicants who score below the adjusted pass mark but still pass will be placed on hold and may be invited to interview at a later date.

Stage 2 Interview

If invited to interview, you will be assessed using techniques aligned with the Civil Service Success Profiles framework, covering all behaviours listed in the job advert and any required technical skills.

Interviews may be in person or via Microsoft Teams.

A reserve list may be held for a period up to 12 months from which further appointments may be made.

The Sift will be conducted from 21/10/2026

Interviews will be conducted from 29/10/2026

For the full terms and conditions of the post, please see attachment.

Near Misses

We often have similar roles available at different grades. If a candidate is suitable for a similar role or a lower grade than they have applied for, we may offer the candidate that role without the need to go through a further selection process providing the role has the same behaviours and essential skills.

Curious about Government Digital and Data? Dive into the [Candidate Pack](#) to learn more

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Government Digital and Data Recruitment Team

Email : Government-Digital-and-Data-
Recruitment@ons.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : About.You@ons.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance, you should contact recruitment.complaints@ons.gov.uk. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission [here](#)

